Shanker Kartik Iyer

Product Designer

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ABOUT

Designer with a software engineering background whose work spans accessible design systems, product strategy, and high-fidelity prototypes. 12+ years of experience solving problem end-to-end shared between early-stage startups and enterprise consulting.

Ties design decisions to measurable outcomes and builds the processes and culture that let teams scale. Thrives working closely with product, engineering, and data in environments of high agency, urgency, and uncertainty. Sweats the details that make software feel considered.

SKILLS

Design Systems
Interaction Design
Typography
Iconography
Accessibility (WCAG 2.2)
Information Architecture

Product Roadmapping
Agile Methodology
Mixed-Methods Research
Storytelling with Data
Workshops & Collaboration
Feature Prioritization

Figma
Paper
Adobe CC
React
TypeScript
CSS Frameworks
Git
AI Coding Agents
MCP Tools

EXPERIENCE

Career Break

Nov 2025 – Present

Lead Product Designer & Product Manager, Spotwork

May 2023 – Nov 2025

Owned the marketplace and operations platform for the on-demand staffing marketplace across US and Canada. Led ground-up platform rebuild, and launched features for floor managers, operations, finance, and sales that doubled daily shifts posted (from 400+ to 800+) in 9 months.

1. **Rolled out and maintain a WCAG AA design system** and ensured compliance through code and UI reviews, minimizing median release cycle time by 38% and **raising release frequency 1.5× (from 17 to 26 releases a year)**.
2. Enabled operations and floor managers to spot fraudulent check-ins with geofenced worksites, and live location tracking during shifts, **cutting attendance disputes 65% (from 90 to 31 a week)**.
3. **Lifted tenth-shift retention from 62% to 78%** by launching a workflow for faster customer activation and effortless schedule extensions, taking new customers from an empty dashboard to booked workers within hours.
4. **Shaped long-term product vision and strategy** by collaborating with cross-functional stakeholders on opportunity areas and uncovering product gaps through customer conversations.
5. **Led product management alongside design** at the recommendation of the departing head of engineering, setting priorities and scope and tasks for an 8-person product team including design, engineering, and data science while delivering hands-on.

Senior Design Consultant, Deloitte Digital
Apr 2019 – Mar 2023

Drove design and UX strategy engagements for US-based Fortune 100 clients, including Caterpillar, Elevance Health, and Costco. As the Delhi studio's founding hire, shaped its culture, hiring, and best practices that sustained its growth to 30+ designers.

1. Built a visual truckload configurator for planning mixed loads of two- and five-seat utility vehicles on multi-car haulers, giving Caterpillar dealers predictable order flow and **lowering freight cost per vehicle by up to 50%**.
2. Elevated Ben E. Keith's sales representatives from order-taking to consultative selling by giving its foodservice buyers **self-serve procurement tools** that freed up their working capital through inventory planning and price optimization.
3. **Mentored 10+ campus and lateral hires** and was recognized as a trusted performer, earning several Deloitte awards and client accolades.

Research Consultant, Gartner
Sep 2017 – Feb 2019

Benchmarked the current-state digital experiences of Irving Oil, BNP Paribas, Novartis and other clients against Gartner's research on emerging technologies. Ran design thinking workshops to frame UX priorities for their digital transformation strategies.

1. Conceptualized emerging-tech prototypes for predictive maintenance and healthcare data platforms to announce Gartner India's CX practice at its Barcelona Symposium.
2. Contributed UX strategy and concept prototypes to 3 RFP responses, giving prospective clients a working view of the proposed experience and **helping win $6.5M in net new business**.

Senior UI/UX Designer, Grapes Digital
Apr 2016 – Aug 2017

Ran full-scale mobile and web design projects for early-stage Indian startups, from research through handoff. Introduced Flexbox-based responsive layouts and atomic design best practices to the team.

Systems Engineer, Tata Consultancy Services
Jan 2012 – Apr 2015

Built CICS interfaces as a mainframe developer before transitioning to product design in year two. Grew from trainee to systems engineer, serving the Canadian Depository for Securities, among other financial institutions.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science
Rajiv Gandhi Technical University

Interaction Design Specialization Certificate
UC San Diego

Product Management Certificate
Indian School of Business

LINKS

Github
https://github.com/ikartik90

Linkedin
https://linkedin.com/in/ikartik90